

Playthrough

Fimbrethil of the Havens, and the line of markers

Playtest run 3 of the TOR2E Character Tracker (SW `tor2e-v128`, harness 280/280). A solo session in Strider Mode, played start to finish with a pre-generated hero, pressing only controls the app offers and finding them by their visible label. 469 driver invocations, **zero page errors**.

Everything in `code` or *italic quotation* below is the app's own text, copied out of the running application. The prose between is mine.

Run 1 built a hero by hand and played one saga. Run 2 played a pregen and re-tested run 1's sixteen fixes. This run does three things: it plays a saga end to end again, it re-tests all seventeen run-2 fixes and the thirteen minors **in play** rather than by reading the diff (GOTCHA 20), and it goes after the surfaces both earlier runs listed as never reached — Opening Volley, Pierce against an Encounter foe, the Moria Archfoe Duel, Restore-Points *restore*, Import Character, the print render, and the 4-Flaws retirement.

I. One tap, and a scholar

The app opened on ► **Play**, which said what it always says and is right to say:

"You need a hero before you can play." — ✨ **Give me a ready-made hero** · 🛠️ **I'll make my own**

The first-run tutorial offer fired on the way ("*Never played before? The guided tutorial runs on a throwaway practice hero*"), and I put it off. From the pregen list I took **Fimbrethil of the Havens** — *Elves of Lindon · Scholar · Str 4 Hrt 3 Wit 7 · End 24 Hope 13* — because she carries a **Great Bow** and I wanted a hero who would actually shoot something (run 2's Ranger had Bows 0, which is why half of combat went untested).

☰ menu → 🛠️ **Solo Play: Strider Mode**. TNs dropped to `14 / 15 / 11`, Fellowship Rating became 3, the free *Strider* feature appeared, and — correctly, per the 2026-08-24 rulebook pass — the experience scheme flipped itself to **Milestone** without being asked.

Her patron is `Gilraen, daughter of Dírhael`, with the acute accent that run 2 found matched no table. It matches now. ► **Begin** — **give me a reason to go** went straight to her:

🏡 **Begin your saga** — "*What sends your hero out? Your patron Gilraen, daughter of Dírhael suggests: **A settlement has come under the eye of the Shadow. Why is this place significant?***"

I answered: because the folk of Combe keep a stone the Elves set there in the First Age, and nobody alive remembers what it is for.

Two turns of  **Ask around for news** gave me the Lore Table twice:

"You listen at the fire and in the doorways. What you hear turns on three things: **Break · Broken · Court.**" "...**Chase · Concealed · Death.**"

A broken court. A concealed death, and something still moving. On the Oracle tab, Telling Table set to **Doubtful**:

Q: *Is the stone at Combe still whole?* · Feat die: 7 · chance: doubtful (yes if ≥ 8) · →
NO

Not weathered down, then. Broken.

II. The road east

I set this journey up on the **Journey tab** rather than from ► Play, deliberately, because the Character tab's own adventure-loop card tells you to: "*Do now: Open the Journey tab, fill in where you are going, and tap ► Start Journey.*" Mithlond → Combe, 8 hexes, 2 of them hard terrain, **Border Land, Forced March, Mounted** with Vigour 4, and a **Peril rating of 2** — three things no previous run had exercised.

It played well. Forced March moved her 2–3 hexes a day and charged +2 Travel Fatigue for the privilege; the peril events arrived tagged  [Peril] independently of the hex path; and every event brought its own roll, which is run 1's finding 2 fixed and still fixed:

► *Ill Choices* – roll Awareness · Awareness  vs TN 14 · hard terrain –1d On a failure, the app applies the event's cost for you.  Roll Awareness · Skip this roll

She failed it, and the app did what run 2 said it would not:

► *Awareness roll for Ill Choices* – 6 vs TN 14: failure – +1 Shadow (0 → 1)

A Despair event later did the same. Eye Awareness climbed from the Eye icons on the Marching Tests — "*Raise by 1 for any Eye icon outside combat*" now genuinely fires on Journey rolls, not only Dice-tab ones.

Arrival was honest about its cost:

"Journey complete! Travel Fatigue accumulated: 13. Mount Vigour 4: –4 → 9. Arrival TRAVEL roll: FAIL (Feat 1, total 9 vs Heart TN 15) → no reduction. Lingering 9 Fatigue added to character Fatigue (0 → 9)."

Nine days on the road; **Day 1** → **Day 8** on the character sheet, which is run 2's minor fixed.

And then the first thing that got in the way. The ► Play tab, which had been told nothing about any of this, still read ****AT YOUR HOME** — "*You are somewhere safe. Nothing is trying to kill you yet.*" **and offered**  Set out on the road**. I pressed it, to see, and it cheerfully asked me where I was going and replaced the whole finished journey with a fresh 4-hex walk — destination, Border Land, forced march, mount and peril all gone, no warning (*Finding 2*). I

restored the snapshot and got in through the side door instead: pressing ► **We set out — begin the journey** on the Character tab *after arriving* finally told Play what had happened, and the recovery the run-1 fix added appeared exactly as designed:

ON THE ROAD TO COMBE, IN BREE-LAND — "The road is behind you — you finished this journey on the Journey tab. Tap **We have arrived** to carry on."

III. Combe, which will not say the word

AT COMBE, IN BREE-LAND — "You have arrived. This is where the thing you came for is — or is not."

👁️ **Look around** gave me "Hinder · Growing · Legend", which is a good answer: the village has built a story on top of the stone, and the story is in the way. 🎲 **Ask a yes/no question** now lets you set the odds — run 2's minor, fixed — so I asked at **Doubtful** whether anyone would talk about the stone. **NO**. I asked at Middling whether the smith's daughter was still in the village. **YES**. Both landed in the Chronicle with the apostrophe intact and the sentences separated, which is run 2's finding 12 fixed:

Q: Is the smith's daughter still in the village? · Telling Table (Middling) → YES You wonder: Is the smith's daughter still in the village? (middling) The answer is YES.

🎯 **Try something** → 📖 **Remember a tale of this** rolled her best skill and it worked: Lore roll 20 vs 11: it works. She knows the stone: not a boundary-mark, a grave-marker, one of a line, and the line runs east.

Making the elders say so took a **Council** — Resistance **Bold (6)**, audience **Reluctant -1d**. She opened with AWE and failed, which set the Time Limit to 3, which made the whole thing unwinnable, which is the correct shape of a bad council. Three attempts, one success, and then:

⌚ Time limit reached. 1 / 6 successes. Choose outcome: "Accept Failure (refused outright) · Success with Woe (achieve the goal at a price)"

The "LM approval" run 1 complained about is gone. She took the Woe: they gave her the name, and she owes Combe something she has not been told the shape of.

Then a **Skill Endeavour** at **Hazardous** risk to open the grave — Resistance 6, Time Limit 4. The first failed roll auto-applied its consequence and said so (⚠️ Failure-with-Woe auto-applied: +2 Fatigue (now 11)), she scored 4 of 6, and it closed as *Failure with Woe*: the turf off, the slab bare, and the night gone.

She went back the next night and forced it, at **Foolish** risk. Foolish risk means a single failed roll ends everything, and hers did. What the app showed for that was nothing at all — the endeavour simply vanished and the log read **No attempts yet.** (Finding 6). The sentence 🧨 **DISASTER on a Foolish endeavour — it fails and cannot be resumed** exists; it is written into `char.skillEndeavour.rolls` and then wiped off the screen a millisecond later.

IV. What came up out of the ground

✂ **Something attacks!** from the Play tab opened the bestiary with a legend I had not seen before — "An attack like 'sword 2d (5/16)' = 2 dice, Damage 5, Injury 16" — and I took a **Barrow-wight** (End 20, Parry 5, Armour 2, Might 2).

First I tested the thing run 2 caught the app lying about. From ✂ **Skirmish** stance I tried to attack with the Cudgel:

⚠ **Cannot attack from Skirmish** — "Cudgel is a melee weapon, and from Skirmish stance melee weapons cannot attack at all — you are too far back to reach the foe. Your options: attack with a ranged weapon instead, or step into a closer stance. **Switch to Open stance now?**"

Blocked, explained, and offered a way out. The Great Bow shot fine from the same stance, with the penalty shown:

You · Great Bow · 6 vs TN 19 (14 Str + Parry 5) → FAIL · miss [Skirmish -1d].

TN 19 is a hard number for a scholar with two ranks of Bows, so she went **Forward** and spent Hope on every shot. Four hits out of seven, four Endurance a time, and a Piercing Blow on a Gandalf rune that the wight shrugged off (Piercing Blow – foe Protection ★ vs 18 → resisted). Its Cold grip found a gap on the way back and the app rolled her Protection for her, and then:

"Wound Severity: **Grievous Injury** 🩹 — **Unconscious & Dying (as if Wounded twice)**"

That is the worst result on the app's own wound table, and it is where this run's most disagreeable finding lives. Nothing happened. No Dying pill, no banner, no timer. The ▶ Play tab kept offering the same five choices, and when I pressed the one it had promoted to the top — ** 🩹 Tend the wound — "A HEALING roll — a Wound will not rest off."*** — it answered:

"No Severe Injury day-count to reduce. (Moderate/Grievous injuries do not use day-tracking.)"

No roll. Not once, not ever. She fought on unconscious and dying, killed the wight in the fourth volley, and stayed Wounded for the rest of the campaign (Finding 4).

The fight folded itself into one Chronicle heading — ✂ Combat vs Barrow-wight – 1 foe · 1 slain · 2 rounds · -8 End · Wounded · -6 Hope — and into the Campaign Timeline, which run 2 found empty and which is now full.

Before I left the barrow I tested the two escape routes. 🏃 **Fly, You Fools!** now offers two real buttons instead of asking you to type a digit, and the Defensive one rolls in place with the foe's Parry in the TN, which is run 2's finding 11 exactly fixed:

You · escape attempt · Great Bow · 8 vs TN 17 (14 Str + Parry 3) · Def -1d → FAIL · you remain engaged

The Rearward one sets your stance and says "On your next action you may escape without a roll" — and there is no control anywhere that performs that escape, ever (Finding 8).

The barrow paid: a **Greater** hoard, tainted, which defaulted the party size to **1** (run 2's finding 14, fixed) and yielded 8 Treasure. From the **Treasure Index** I took the Horn of Boromir's stat line, renamed it *The Silver-Tipped Horn of the Barrow*, and ticked ⚠ **Cursed** — **Shadow Taint**. The Greed test failed:

"Wisdom Test: FAIL (Feat 8, 0 ♦ vs Wits TN 11). Reduction: -0. Net Shadow gain: 1 (2 → 3). ⚠ CURSED (Shadow Taint). You will gain +1 Shadow each Fellowship Phase while bearing this item."

She kept it. That turns out to be the whole story.

V. The road home, on which nothing happens

✅ **Our business here is done** → 🏠 **Set out for home** → "The way we came" → a 9-hex return. Run 1's finding 11 is genuinely fixed: the road home can be travelled now, in the same units as the road out (2 stretches in 2 days; you are 4 of 9 of the way), and a Gandalf rune reads as "a Gandalf rune — automatic success" rather than an em-dash.

What does not happen on the road home is **anything**. The app scheduled a Journey Event at hex 7, then at hex 8, and the ▶ Play tab never mentioned either one; it offered "🏠 Travel onward" right past them, both times, all the way home (Finding 1). The outbound leg surfaces them correctly — I checked, on the second adventure, and got the exact control run 2's fix added ("⚠ Something happens on the road — Resolve it before you travel on."). The fix was applied to one of the two legs.

🏠 **We are safe again** moved the loop to the Fellowship Phase — and left `char.journey.active` true, so the Journey tab spent the rest of the campaign displaying an in-progress journey to a place called `home` with an unresolved event waiting at hex 8.

VI. Four Fellowship Phases

This is the part run 2 could not reach at all, because the phase it fixed could only be run once. It can be run four times now. I ran four.

Phase 1, Ordinary. Step 2 previewed everything before committing anything — "Current: 7 / 13 → will become 10 (+3)" and "⚠ Shadow Taint: 1 cursed item (The Silver-Tipped Horn of the Barrow) → +1 Shadow this phase". I closed the app between step 1 and step 2 to check, and reopening put me back on step 2 with the phase type intact. Applying Recovery a second time was refused. Step 3 opened **Spend Skill Points** above the wizard — `z-index 240` against the wizard's 200, and **19 of 19 buttons hit-testable**, which is run 2's finding 2 dead. Step 4 took *Ponder Storied and Figured Maps* (free for a Scholar) and *Write a Song*, and I wrote her one: *The Lay of the Broken Marker* — "Of a court that does not sit, and a name Combe would not say."

Inside that phase I bought a Valour rank, and the picker that grants the Reward opened. I closed the app on it, the way you do. On the next load the Character tab carried a standing control:

"You have earned 1 Reward that has not been chosen yet. Ranks of Valour grant a Reward; ranks of Wisdom grant a Virtue." — 🎁 **Choose your Reward**

That is run 2's finding 3 fixed, and it is a good fix. It is also only half the path. Claiming the Reward opens a second dialog — "Apply Keen to... Great Bow / Cudgel / Cancel" — and **Cancel** at that step decrements the owed counter, applies nothing, and leaves you with no Reward and nothing owed (*Finding 3*). I lost two Rewards this way, 16 Adventure Points for nothing, before I worked out what was happening.

The same phase also sold me a **second Valour rank** — Valour 1 → 2 → 3 in one Fellowship Phase — while the Wisdom row beside it was locked with "Already raised Valour this Fellowship Phase — Valour and Wisdom are exclusive per phase (RAW p.119)" and the card above listed "Max 1 rank per Skill per phase" (*Finding 7*).

Phase 2, Yule. Age 135 → 136, +7 Skill Points from Wits, all Hope back, the year rolled to

1. **Heal Scars** took the Shadow Scar she had bought with Harden Will; **Raise an Heir** made

Faelivrin with 3 Previous Experience for 3 AP and 3 Treasure. Both Yule-only undertakings work.

Phases 3 and 4 were routine, which is the point: `phasesCompleted: 4`, `fpWizardState: null` after each, Eye Awareness reset to its starting value each time, Strengthen Fellowship raising Fellowship Rating to 4 and then correctly expiring one phase later.

What four Fellowship Phases did not do was heal her. After all of them she was still `Wounded`, still carrying `Grievous Injury` — `Unconscious & Dying`, still at 16/24 Endurance with 11 Fatigue. The only thing in the app that clears a Grievous wound is un-ticking the Wounded checkbox yourself.

VII. The Midgewater, and four names

► **Begin the next adventure** asked for a new reason, seeded from the Patron, which is run 1's minor fixed. I gave it the debt: Combe wants the rest of the line of markers found and sealed.

The outbound journey ran from ► Play this time, and the Journey Events appeared as promised, with Ponder Maps visibly doing its job: `Ill Choices (Feat 3 Ponder Maps +1, region wild)`. At the marshes the Lore Table said "Trick · Weary · Wealth" and the Telling Table said the second marker was **not** still sealed. Someone has been working west to east, prying up slabs and taking what the Númenóreans buried with their dead.

She had been carrying one of those things since Combe, and she knew it.

Eye Awareness hit the Hunt Threshold and the **Revelation Episode** fired with the inline reset run 1 asked for:

👁 **Revelation Episode (Feat 7) — Important location lost.** "A place vital to your mission is overtaken by an enemy. Play this out. Once it is resolved, Eye Awareness resets and the tally begins again." — 🏹 **Resolved** — **reset the Eye** · **Not yet**

Then the Shadow. The horn's taint had been adding a point every phase and the marshes added more, and at `Shadow 13 / Max Hope 13` the **Bout of Madness** fired. I let the prompt go — closed the app on it, which is how run 2's hero got trapped forever — and on the next load the Character tab had a standing 🟦 **Face the Bout of Madness** button, and **Clear Shadow** → +1 Scar was clickable rather than dead, and pressing it explained itself:

"Harden Will is unavailable: your Shadow (13) + Scars (0) already matches or exceeds Max Hope (13). At this point only a Bout of Madness can clear your Shadow — face it with the "Face the Bout of Madness" button on this tab, or run a Fellowship Phase to recover Shadow."

That is run 2's finding 9, and GOTCHA 21, both honoured.

The Bout itself asks you to type a number. The first time it offered `1. Haughty 2. Scornful

1. Scheming 4. Traitorous` and I took Scheming. The second time it offered only the two she did

not have — **2. Scornful** and **4. Traitorous** — and out of habit I typed **1**. It cleared all 13 Shadow, gave her no Flaw, marked the bout resolved and said nothing whatsoever (*Finding 5*). I did that twice before noticing.

Four bouts, four Flaws — Scheming, Haughty, Scornful, Traitorous, the whole of *Lure of Secrets* — and then the fifth:

 **SUCCUMB TO SHADOW** — "Shadow (13) reached Max Hope (13) and you already bear all 4 Flaws of "Lure of Secrets". Your hero, an Elf, can no longer bear the Shadow of Middle-earth. They sail for the Uttermost West — Valinor — to be healed of sadness and misery. Your hero is removed from play. Export a JSON backup before resetting — you may want to bring them back as an NPC, raise their Heir, or revisit them in flashback."

That is the 4-Flaws retirement run 2 was locked out of, and it is a good piece of writing: culture-aware, and it points at the Heir she made at Yule.

RETIRED appeared in the header. The saga card noticed — "This could be an ending. • Your hero has already succumbed — the story has ended itself." The ► Play tab did not; it went on offering  **Something attacks!** to a woman who had sailed West (*Finding 13*).

 **Bring your saga to a close**, and the last line:

She never gave the horn back. She carried it out of the Midgewater and west along the line of markers, and by the time she reached Mithlond there were four names for what she had become and every one of them was true. Faelivrin has the maps now, and the debt to Combe, and the third marker is still sealed. Fimbrethil took ship at the Grey Havens with the horn in her pack, because she could not put it down, and that is the ending she earned rather than the one she wanted.

"Fimbrethil of the Havens' tale is finished. Export the Chronicle from that tab to keep it."

Final sheet: Elf of Lindon, Scholar · Valour 3 · Wisdom 1 · 4 Flaws · 2 sessions · 2 adventures · 4 Fellowship Phases · one cursed Númenórean horn · an heir named Faelivrin · retired, *Sailed for Valinor (Shadow)*. The Chronicle holds **7 scenes and 208 blocks**, dated forward from *Spring, 1st Astron 2965* to *Winter, 11th Afteryule 2966*.

VIII. Under the Mountain, and the rest of the app

With the saga closed I took **Duinhir 'Eaglenose'**, the Ranger, into **Moria**, and then went through everything neither earlier run had touched.

Moria enabled cleanly and gave what it promises — `patron: "Balin, son of Fundin"` (a key that now resolves: *"Patron Quest from Balin, son of Fundin (Success die: 2)"*), Safe Haven Moria — *First Hall*, Hunt 12, +5 Hope — and restored his own Patron, haven and region on the way out. Six **distinct** dwarves from + **Roll 6 Starting Allies**. Mission planning applied *"Readiness 4* (TN

1. · Burden heavy · Dispositions — Exp 2, Man 2, Rally 2, Vig 3, War 3 · Eye Awareness 4 · Hunt

Threshold 12". The **Endurance** and **Fatigue Tests** injured and fatigued a named ally each (`Dári is now FATIGUED`). A **Desperate Stand** let Dúrnir step in and survive on an Eye.

The **Battle** ran: a War Party rolled *Pack — Might 1, Resistance 6*, a Lesser Archfoe, an objective, a Get-in-Position failure that handed me a Complication, and Clash rounds whose dice pool the app computed correctly down to zero (`War 0d vs Readiness TN 17` with three -1d modifiers stacked). And the thing run 1 and run 2 both failed on — a banked Clash success surviving a reload — now works completely:

`✕ -1 Foe Resistance` · `🎯 -1 Objective` · `▲ Gain Advantage` · `💀 Harry Archfoe (+1d duel)` — all four **visible and hit-testable** on a cold page load with `_pendingSpend: 1`.

The **Archfoe Duel** is a signpost, as documented, and a thin one: *"fight the Archfoe with the normal combat rules (Combat + Dice tabs) for 3 close-quarters rounds"* — with no stat block created, nothing to add to the Encounter, and the *"Harry the Archfoe"* bonus it tells you to spend going nowhere at all (*Finding 12*).

The **Moria Fellowship Phase** answered run 2's finding 16 in one line:

"🌿 Brief Fellowship Phase — +3 Hope (half Heart — Rangers) · Endurance fully restored · Cleared 3 ally condition(s) · Eye Awareness reset"

Also reached, for the record: the Moria **Chamber** and **Orc-Band** generators and the four-column Moria Lore table; **Opening Volley** (a buckler's +1 Parry doubling to *"Parry vs ranged this exchange: 21"* against a Parry Total of 20 — and then not being used by anything, *Finding 9*); the **GM Screen** and a **Group Shadow Test** rolled across four heroes at four different TNs; **Party View**; **Table Mode**; **Campaign Timeline**; the **Undo** button; theme, text-size and compact cycling; the **Reference** tab's filter; **Export/Import Character** round-trip; **Export ALL / Restore Heroes**; a **Restore Point** actually restored (End 27 → 25, Parry 15 → 16, the Lifepath adjustment rolled back) and still undoable afterwards; the **print render**; the **share link**; and the **tutorial**, including its boot-time sandbox recovery, its interactive *"👉 Try it on the page →"* steps auto-advancing when you do the thing, and the practice hero's **📁 Keep / 🗑 Discard**.

Findings

Ranked by how much they got in the way. Every quotation is the app's own text.

1 — The road home has no Journey Events. The fix reached one leg of the journey. (dead end in the fiction)

Beat V. `_playStepChoices()` gained a `_playEventDue()` branch for `case 'journey'` (`src/04-render.js:3961-3966`) and `case 'home'` **did not** (`:3997-4001`). The return leg is a real journey — `playSetOutHome()` builds one, `playTravel()` advances it through `applyMarchingTestResult()`, which schedules `nextEventHex` exactly as it does outbound. I travelled 9 hexes home with `nextEventHex: 7` and then `8` sitting on the character, and Play offered " *Travel onward*" every single time. On arrival, `playGoStep('fellowship')` left `char.journey.active === true`, so the Journey tab was still showing Combe, in Bree-land → home · 8 / 8 hexes · NEXT EVENT hex 8 for the rest of the campaign.

Half of every adventure's travel — the return road the app added a whole control for — has no pressure in it.

2 — A journey started on the Journey tab is invisible to ► Play, which then silently destroys it. (silent state change)

Beat II. The Character tab's adventure-loop card says "*Do now: Open the Journey tab, fill in where you are going, and tap ► Start Journey.*" Doing that leaves `char.saga.step` on `'haven'`, because only `playSetOut()` advances it. So with an 8-hex mounted forced march to Combe live and 0/8 covered, ► Play read:

AT YOUR HOME — "*You are somewhere safe. Nothing is trying to kill you yet.*"  **Set out on the road** — "*Begin the journey to wherever this takes you.*"

Pressing it asked "*Where are you going?*", asked how far, and **overwrote the live journey with no confirmation** (`src/04-render.js:4165`): destination, 8 hexes, Border Land, Forced March, Mounted

- Vigour 4 and Peril 2 replaced by a 4-hex wild-land walk. The Journey tab's "Journey in Progress"

card was now describing a different journey.

Recovery exists but reads as nonsense: you press ► **We set out — begin the journey** on the Character tab *after you have arrived*, and it answers "*Do now: Open the Journey tab, fill in where you are going, and tap ► Start Journey.*"

3 — A Reward you earned is destroyed if you cancel the "Apply to..." step. (described capability, no control)

Beat VI. Run 2's finding 3 is fixed one level deep: abandoning the  **Pick a New Reward** picker now leaves a standing "*You have earned 1 Reward that has not been chosen yet*" +  **Choose your Reward** on the Character tab, and it survives a reload. But `pickNewReward()` decrements the counter **before** the apply step runs:

```
function pickNewReward(name) {
  closeNewReward();
  char.pendingRewards = Math.max(0, (parseInt(char.pendingRewards) || 0) - 1);
  saveCharacter();
  promptApplyReward(name, 'new');      // ← cancel here and the Reward is gone
}
```

src/05-combat-build.js:2508-2512

Reproduced twice, once by closing the app on the "Apply Keen to..." dialog and once by pressing its own **Cancel**:
 pendingRewards → 0, char.rewards unchanged, #owed-picks hidden after reload. Two Valour ranks (16 AP) bought and neither Reward received.

4 — The worst wound in the game has no effect, no countdown, and the control offered for it refuses every time. (*dead end in the fiction*)

Beat IV, and every beat after it. rollWoundSeverity() returns { label: 'Grievous Injury 🩹', detail: 'Unconscious & Dying (as if Wounded twice)', days: 0 } (src/05-combat-build.js:930). The app then does nothing with it: no Dying state, no prompt, no timer, the same five ► Play choices, and full agency — she shot a bow the same second.

Because days: 0, rollFirstAid() refuses (src/05-combat-build.js:153), and ► Play's 🩹 **Tend the wound** — the choice the app promotes to the top of the list while you are Wounded, captioned "A HEALING roll — a Wound will not rest off." — answers, forever:

"No Severe Injury day-count to reduce. (Moderate/Grievous injuries do not use day-tracking.)"

Four Fellowship Phases did not clear it either. The only route out of a Grievous or Moderate wound in the whole app is un-ticking the Wounded checkbox by hand, which nothing tells you.

5 — A number the Bout of Madness did not offer silently clears all your Shadow and gives you no Flaw. (*silent refusal, on the most consequential prompt in the game*)

Beat VII. The prompt numbers the remaining Flaws by their *original* index, so on a second bout it reads:

"Pick a Flaw to add (only un-owned shown): 2. Scornful 4. Traitorous. Enter the number — or Cancel to skip and just clear Shadow."

Typing 1 (or 3, or junk) falls straight through the guard and the next two lines run regardless:

```
if (n >= 1 && n <= 4 && flaws[n-1] && !flawsField.includes(flaws[n-1])) { ...add flaw... }
char.shadow = 0;
char.boutDue = false;      // resolved
```

src/04-render.js:231-242

13 Shadow wiped, no Flaw taken, the bout consumed, and **not one word on screen**. It is also the strictly better outcome, so a player who mistypes is quietly rewarded. Every other picker in the app is a button list; this one asks you to type a digit.

6 — A Foolish Skill Endeavour's Disaster is never shown to the player. (*silent state change*)

Beat III. `finalizeSkillEndeavour('disaster')` deliberately forces the outcome cards visible — "keeps the active+log cards visible with the outcome" — and then its caller runs `render()` on the very next line, which re-enters `renderSkillEndeavour()`, takes the `!e.active` branch and hides all three cards (`src/04-render.js:1063-1067` vs `:900`, `:976-980`).

What a player sees: the endeavour disappears, the setup card returns, and the log reads `No attempts yet.` No dialog fires. The text `DISASTER on a Foolish endeavour – it fails and cannot be resumed` exists only inside `char.skillEndeavour.rolls`, which is no longer rendered.

7 — The Fellowship Phase sells a second Valour rank in the same phase while telling you it cannot. (*rules enforcement gap*)

Beat VI. Step 3 prints "Max 1 rank per Skill per phase · Max 1 rank per Combat Proficiency per phase · Either Valour OR Wisdom (not both)", and the Spend AP modal enforces the first two by name (`Spears` came back as `FP` — Already raised "Spears" this Fellowship Phase). `fpSpendBlocker` checks Valour only against **Wisdom** (`src/05-combat-build.js:2343`), so Valour is never checked against itself: I bought Valour 1 → 2 → 3 in one phase (`fpSpend.valour: 2`) with the Wisdom row locked beside it.

8 — "Fall back (Rearward)" promises an escape and nothing in the app performs it. (*described capability, no control*)

Beat IV. Choosing it sets the stance and says:

"Stance set to Rearward. On your next action you may escape without a roll — you cannot attack or take a Combat Task from Rearward."

`flyYouFools()`'s rearward branch (`src/04-render.js:3444-3450`) never clears `foe.engaged` and there is no other control that does. Pressing `Fly, You Fools!` again just re-offers the same two options. The only way out of the fight is `End encounter`, which ends the whole thing for everyone. The Defensive half of the same dialog is fully implemented, which makes the gap harder to spot.

9 — Opening Volley computes a doubled Parry and nothing ever reads it. (*described capability with no effect*)

Beat VIII. With a Buckler equipped and the toggle on, the card says:

`PARRY TOTAL 20` · `Opening Volley (aware) – ON` · "Parry vs ranged this exchange: 21 — shield Parry bonus doubled (aware of the volley) — Core Rules p.93"

I then had a Goblin Archer shoot her:

Goblin Archer · Black bow · 18 vs your Parry 20 · you Forward +1d → miss

`char.openingVolley` is read in exactly one place, `renderProtectionParry` (`src/05-combat-build.js:683`); `foeAttackHero` computes `tn = char.parry + char.shieldTotal` (`src/05-combat-build.js:1208`) and never looks at it. The toggle produces a number and no effect.

10 — Pierce cannot be used against an Encounter foe — the surface the app tells you to fight on. *(described capability, no control)*

Beat IV. The Combat tab's own intro says "Add foes under Encounter to run the whole fight here (attack, take hits, track wounds)." The  **Pierce: spend 1**  button — Swords +1, Bows +2, Spears +3 to the Feat die — is injected only by `rollDice()` on the Dice tab (`src/06-tabs-init.js:829-844`). I landed **SUCCESS (1+)** and **SUCCESS (2+)** with a Bow inside the Encounter and was offered nothing. A Core Rules combat option the app implements is unreachable from the place it asks you to fight.

11 — Undertakings picked in the Fellowship Phase wizard are lost on a reload, which its own step 3 says cannot happen. *(a lie in the record)*

Beat VI. Step 3 reads: "If you do close it, your phase type, Recovery **and undertakings** are kept, and re-opening puts you back on this step." `fpToggleUndertaking()` (`src/04-render.js:643-668`) ends in `fpRenderStep4()` and never calls `fpPersist()`. Selecting *Ponder Maps + Write a Song*, then reloading, gave `selectedUndertakings: []`. Pressing the wizard's own **Close** does persist them — so the failure mode is precisely the one a phone PWA produces: background the app, come back, your picks are gone and the app told you they would not be.

12 — "Harry the Archfoe" banks a bonus nothing reads, and the Duel has no foe. *(described capability, no control)*

Beat VIII. `clashSpend('harry')` writes one log line — "Harry the Archfoe — +1d to spend in the duel" (`src/04-render.js:1951`) — and stores nothing. The Duel itself is an `alert` telling you to go and fight on the Combat tab (`src/04-render.js:1813`), with no Archfoe stat block generated, no "add to Encounter" control, and no way to apply the bonus you were told to bank. The glossary repeats the promise: "They worsen your rolls until you spend successes to Harry them."

13 — **Play does not notice that your hero has retired.** *(silent state change)*

Beat VII. With `char.retired = true` and `retiredReason: "Sailed for Valinor (Shadow)"`, the header shows **RETIRED** and the saga card says "Your hero has already succumbed — the story has ended itself." The  Play tab shows the same situation and the same five choices, including  **Something attacks!**. `_playStepChoices()` has no `retired` branch; the tab's empty states key on `saga.ended` only.

14 — The printed character sheet now includes the ► Play tab and the entire GM Screen. (presentation)

Beat VIII. Rendered under `media: print`, the hidden-panel list at `styles.css:652-653` covers Dice / Build / Oracle / Band / Battle / Journey / Council / Reference — every tab that existed when it was written. `#panel-play` and `#panel-gm` were added later and are not in it, so both print: 25,467 characters of body text, including the Play tab's current situation and every hero in the roster with their hand-out controls. (GOTCHA 15 says adding a shipped file means three edits; adding a *tab* apparently means four.)

15 — The Fellowship Phase's refusal gives false advice. (a lie in the record)

Beat VI. Pressing **Apply Recovery** twice answers *"Recovery already applied this session. Cancel and reopen to redo."* Cancelling and reopening does **not** redo it — the whole point of the run-1 fix is that `recoveryApplied` is now durable, and it is: I verified across two reloads that Hope and Shadow stay put. The guard is right and its sentence is wrong. Run 2 reported this line; it was not changed.

16 — Fortune and Ill-Fortune are still never offered outside the Dice tab, and the Oracle tab says they will be. (described capability, no control)

Beats II, III, VIII. The Oracle tab's own banner reads:

"Reactive tables — you rarely come here for these. When one of your ordinary rolls turns up a ☉ Rune or an 👁 Eye, the dice result offers a one-tap button to roll the matching table right there. These are the manual fallback."

On the Dice tab that is true (`#strider-fortune-action` renders and is hit-testable on a Rune). On every other surface it is not: `_soloEyeFromRoll()` (`src/04-render.js:1430-1437`) raises the Eye and returns, and its own comment claims the Rune case *"offers the Fortune table"* when no code does. I rolled Gandalf runes on a Marching Test, a Peril event and a Clash, and an Eye on two Marching Tests, and was offered nothing any of the five times. Run 2 reported both halves of this; one half was fixed.

17 — Journey events pasted into the ► Play feed run their sentences together. (a gap in the record)

Beat VII. Run 2's finding 12 was fixed by giving `playSay()` a `_playPlainText()` helper (`src/04-render.js:3862`). `playEvent()` does not use it — it does `String(ev.text).replace(/<[^>]+>/g, '')` (`src/04-render.js:4136`), which strips the `<br>`s and welds the clauses:

👁 Ill Choices (Feat 3 🗺 Ponder Maps +1, region wild). Roll: Awareness. +2 Travel Fatigue. If the skill roll fails: target gains +1 Shadow (Dread)Overlooked hazard – escape safelySub-event roll: 3 · Skill: Awareness► Roll Awareness.

That is what goes into the Chronicle.

18 — A fell ability that fires at "start of round 1" is never shown at round 1. (*described rule, surfaced too late*)

Beat VIII. `_encRoundFellPrompt()` is called only from `nextRound()` (`src/05-combat-build.js:960`), and an encounter opens at round 1 without one. Adding the **Forgotten Dead** produced no prompt; pressing **Next round ▶** produced:

★ *Fell abilities — "Round 2 — these fell abilities are in play. The app does not apply them for you: **Forgotten Dead** ... Thing of Terror: Start of round 1: all heroes gain 3 Shadow (Dread)..."*

The prompt quotes an ability that has already not fired.

19 — Smaller things, one line each

- **Duinhir 'Eaglenose' tale is finished.** `possessive()` treats a trailing `'` as if it were an

s(`src/01-core.js:254`), so the app's own pregen gets a bare `'`. Run 2 reported `'s`; this is the other wrong answer.

- The **share link is 6,092 characters** for a played hero (down from run 2's 15,056, still five

times the 1,200-char QR gate, so the QR still refuses). The delta carries `saga` (756 chars of premise and ending prose), all 18 `skills`, the live `journey`, and the in-progress `council` and `skillEndeavour` — none of which a character transfer needs.

- **Unnamed heroes read as ?** on the **GM Screen** and in **Party View**, and **Restore Points**

heads every row with the raw hero id (`cmtzhfzwggggg 9/13/2026, 7:22:29 AM · on opening the app · ♥ 27/27`). Table Mode's fix ("*Unnamed hero*", or the culture) was not carried to the other three.

- The **Moria enable dialog** reads "*PE budget: → 15 (solo)*" — the "from" value is empty.
- ▶ Play writes "*Ill Choices — it wants a Awareness roll.*"
- A **Joyful Sight** you fail logs "*failure — the event's effect stands*", which sounds like a

penalty; that event has no failure cost at all.

- The Journey tab renders the return leg's region as "**wild Land**" (lowercase), because

`playSetOutHome()` writes `'wild'` while the setup form writes `'Wild'` — and "*The way we came*" silently changes the region from the outbound Border Land to Wild.

- The scene the return leg opens is titled "**The road home to home**".
- The **Chronicle records interface chatter**: *"Read those as a rumour. If they mean nothing to*

you, tap again — that is allowed." is stored as a journal entry, and every ▶ Play oracle ask writes two blocks (the structured Q: ... line and the narrated "You wonder: ...")*.

- The **Orc-Band generator** prints one bullet per Success die (`` 2 Orc Soldiers · 1 Orc Soldier · 1 Orc Soldier ...``) without tallying, and offers no way to put the band into the Encounter.

- **Eye Awareness has no ceiling** — the header pill happily read  106/16  and the Revelation

never re-fired.

- The **Campaign Timeline's own blurb** still says it records *"session XP, Shadow & Scar gains,*

Valour/Wisdom rank-ups, and Fellowship Phases"; it now also records journeys, councils, endeavours, fights, Harden Will and adventures, which is better than advertised.

- ***Apply Culture writes the culture's age range into the Age field*** (), so the

Build checklist ticks "Set an Age" with a string.

- **Zero genuine console errors** across 469 driver invocations.

Verification of the run-2 fixes

#	Run-2 finding	Verdict	What proves it
1	Fellowship Phase runnable only once (the shipped regression)	held	Four phases completed on one hero across dozens of reloads; <code>fpWizardState: null</code> after each <code>fpComplete</code> , <code>recoveryApplied: false</code> on each reopen
2	FP step 3 opens Spend XP <i>behind</i> the wizard	held	<code>spend-xp-overlay</code> z-index 240 vs wizard 200 ; 19 of 19 buttons hit-testable via <code>elementFromPoint</code>
3	An unspent rank-up is lost forever	held with caveats	Abandoning the picker leaves "You have earned 1 Reward that has not been chosen yet" + a standing claim button that survives reload — but cancelling the "Apply to..." step still destroys it (Finding 3)
4	Journey Events unreachable from ► Play	held with caveats	"⚠️ Something happens on the road — Resolve it before you travel on." blocks travel outbound — but case 'home' was not fixed (Finding 1)
5	Clash spend rendered into a <code>display:none</code> parent	held	Cold load with <code>_pendingSpend: 1</code> : all four spend buttons <code>vis: true</code> , <code>hit: true</code> , <code>#b-spend</code> now a child of <code>#battle-active-card</code>
6	A journey event's failure branch applies nothing	held	"► Awareness roll for Ill Choices — 6 vs TN 14: failure — +1 Shadow (0 → 1) ", and the same on Despair
7	Pregen / Moria Patron keys match no table	held	<code>Gilraen, daughter of Dírhael</code> seeds <code>sagaBegin</code> and rolls a Patron Quest; Moria sets <code>Balin, son of Fundin</code> and its quest table resolves
8	Lifepath Parry ±1 erased on the next render	held	Major Event die 9 → <code>parry 16 → 15</code> , <code>parryAdjust: -1</code> , survives reloads and tab switches
9	An abandoned Bout locks permanent Despair	held	Prompt lost, reload → <code>boutDue: true</code> + standing 🟢 Face the Bout of Madness; Clear Shadow → +1 Scar not <code>disabled</code> , hit-testable, and its guard names the route
10	Skirmish/Rearward say melee cannot attack, then allow it	held	"Cudgel is a melee weapon, and from Skirmish stance melee weapons cannot attack at all... Switch to Open stance now?" — foe untouched; the Bow still fires with <code>[Skirmish -1d]</code>
11	"Fly, You Fools!" rolls at the wrong TN	held with caveats	Defensive escape rolls in place: <code>8 vs TN 17 (14 Str + Parry 3) · Def -1d</code> . The Rearward half has no control at all (Finding 8)
12	► Play corrupts apostrophes in the Chronicle	held	<code>Q: Is the smith's daughter still in the village? ... The answer is YES.</code> — real apostrophe, sentences separated
13	Campaign Timeline recorded none of the adventure	held	Journey, Council, Skill Endeavour ×2, the fight, Harden Will, rank-ups, FPs and both saga beats all present; **session recap shows the three <i>newest</i> ** entries
14	Hoard roller defaults to a party of four in solo	held	<code>hoard-party-size = 1</code> ; "8 per hero (× 1 heroes = 8 total)"
15	2h grip unavailable on every pregen	held	Duinhir's Long Sword ships <code>inj1h 16 / inj2h 18 / grip 1h</code> ; the <code>1h</code> button is visible + hit-testable and flips Injury to 18
16	Moria missed three run-1 fixes	held	Revelation offers 🟢 Resolved — reset the Eye inline; "+3 Hope (half Heart — Rangers)"; "Eye Awareness reset"; Patron resolves

#	Run-2 finding	Verdict	What proves it
17	Eye Awareness rises only on Dice-tab rolls	held with caveats	Eye rose on Marching Tests, journey-event rolls and Shadow gains, and did not rise during combat. Fortune/Ill-Fortune are still offered only on the Dice tab (Finding 16)

The thirteen minors: PE card reads 15 pts in solo ✓ · end-session confirm no longer promises Milestone heroes XP ✓ · Oracle Fortune/Ill-Fortune cards no longer gate on success/failure ✓ · ► Play picks the Telling Table odds band ✓ · Play vitals show WEARY? ✓ · Spend SP / Spend AP and Roll backstory / Roll event distinguishable ✓ · days pass on the road (Day 1 → Day 8 over a nine-day march) ✓ (*injury-day ticking untestable* — *the wound rolled had days: 0*) · fell abilities with a round trigger are put in front of you each round ✓ (*but never at round 1 — Finding 18*) · **share link under the QR gate** ✗ — **6,092 chars against a 1,200 gate** · Duinhir 'Eaglenose' possessive ⚠ (*no longer ' 's , now ' '*) · Restore Points rows distinguishable ✓ (*but headed by the raw hero id*) · Table Mode names a nameless hero ✓ (*GM tab and Party View still ?*) · ► Play opens a Chronicle scene at each break ✓ · both tutorial "Try it" steps interactive and auto-advancing ✓ · practice-hero **Keep / Discard** buttons ✓.

Tally: 12 held cleanly · 4 held with caveats · 1 minor not met · 0 regressed.

Run-1 fixes spot-checked again and still holding: Shadow Tests / Combat Tasks reachable on a cold Dice tab (#roll-result still display:none , all nine buttons hit-testable); the session recap in correct order; the Eye hint listing all five regions and the Band preview reading Hunt Threshold: 12 (12 +0) ; Moria's Patron/Haven/region stashed and restored on exit; six distinct starting dwarves; "Begin the next adventure" asking for the new reason; the Council and Endeavour modifier captions sitting above their skill grids; the Dying banner on ► Play; and journey units matching between Play and the Journey tab.

Coverage delta

Newly reached this run (both earlier runs listed these as uncovered): **Opening Volley** with a shield equipped and against a real ranged foe attack · the **Moria Archfoe Duel** · **Restore Points actually restored** (and shown still undoable) · **Import Character (JSON)** and the bulk **Restore Heroes** round trip · the **print render** under media: print · the **4-Flaws retirement** all the way to succumbing, which run 2 was locked out of · **Skill Endeavour at all three Risk levels** including Foolish → Disaster · **Council to Success-with-Woe** · **Peril events** · **Forced March** · **Mounted travel with Vigour** consumed on arrival · the **Treasure Index** picker with a **cursed Shadow-Taint** item taken through four Fellowship Phases · **Raise an Heir** · **Write a Song** · **Ponder Maps'** +1 visible in a journey event · **Strengthen Fellowship** raising and then expiring · **Heal Scars** at Yule · the Band's **Endurance and Fatigue Tests** · **Desperate Stand** · a **Clash spend after a cold reload** · the **GM tab's Group Shadow Test** across four heroes with a hand-out written through to a non-active hero · **Party View**, **Table Mode**, **Campaign Timeline**, **Undo**, theme / text-size / compact cycling, and the **Reference** filter · the **tutorial's** boot-time sandbox recovery, an interactive step auto-advancing, and **Keep/Discard**.

Still unreached.

- **Cloud**, **campaigns**, the **live Fellowship**, **shared encounters** and **Loremaster broadcast**. The

harness stubs the Firebase SDK and the app correctly reports " *Firebase SDK not loaded*".

- **Group play of any kind** — Support given by a real ally, a Fellowship Focus that does something,

GM hand-outs to a remote hero.

- **Protection rolls against anything but a Piercing Blow**, and **Pierce itself** (unreachable from

the Encounter — Finding 10; I did not go to the Dice tab to use it out of context).

- **The Moria journey event table** and Moria Marching Tests (run 2 covered these; I ran the Moria

generators and Band/Battle instead).

- **Famous Weapon dormant qualities** and the **Visiting the Treasury** unlock path.
- **Recount a Story** (the third Yule undertaking), **Study Magical Items**, **Meet Patron** and

Gather Rumours as full undertakings rather than as list entries.

- **Injury-day tracking and First Aid's** **1 + +** **reduction**, because the only wound this campaign

rolled was Grievous, which has no days. Run 1 covered it.

- **The share-link import round trip** on a second device (run 2 covered the hash import).
- **Nine of the ten tutorial lessons**.
- **Long-run balance**. One saga, two adventures, two sessions, four Fellowship Phases. Nothing here

says whether XP, Eye Awareness or Shadow pace correctly over twenty sessions. What I can say is that the horn's **+1 Shadow each Fellowship Phase** plus ordinary adventure Shadow did, unprompted, carry an Elf from clean to retired in two adventures, and that felt about right.

- **Whether the fiction was any good**. *Break · Broken · Court* → *Chase · Concealed · Death* →

Hinder · Growing · Legend → *Trick · Weary · Wealth* converged, without steering, on a coherent story about a line of graves being robbed from the west and a village that had built a legend over the first one to avoid saying so. The Telling Table then answered the two questions that mattered with an inconvenient **NO** each time, and the session was better for both. It worked this time. I still cannot say it generalises.

Two notes on method

Probe artifacts I chased and discarded, recorded so the next run does not chase them again:

- ****One new `tor2e-char-` slot appeared per page load*** — 378 orphan slots against a 4-hero roster.

That was *my driver*: `tests/browser.js` does its own `goto()` with empty storage before the state-restoring init script is installed, so the app builds a blank hero on that first load and the restore did not clear it. Fixed by clearing before re-applying the store. Nothing wrong with the app.

- **Every control on the Dice tab reported un-hit-testable** — an unrelated `styled-modal-overlay`

from an unfinished tutorial exit was still open. Always check `occludedBy` before believing a hit-test failure.

- **Every Chronicle scene showed the same date** — scenes carry `sc.date`, not `sc.clock`, and `journal.scenes` is stored **oldest-first**. Run 2's driver reversed it and read the wrong key. The Tale of Years is fine.
- **The War Gear table looked empty and the `ch-month` picker looked to be missing Foreyule** — `innerText` does not return `<input value>`, and my own output truncation. Both fine.

What the driver gained this run, and why: a real **hit-test** (`elementFromPoint` at three points, after scrolling into view, reporting what occludes) so that "the button is there" and "a finger can press it" stop being the same claim — that distinction is what GOTCHA 20 is about, and it is what proved findings 3, 5 and 2 of run 2 genuinely fixed rather than cosmetically fixed; a `near "<row text>" "<button>"` step, because Spend XP renders every button as a bare `N pts` and a player tells them apart by the skill name printed beside it; a `doin "<card>" "<label>"` step, because two cards on the Combat tab both offer a bare **Pick**; and `grabfile / upload` so export and import could be round-tripped through the app's own file controls rather than reimplemented.